

OPINIONS ON THE METAVERSE Remain A Mixed Bag

CES 2023 renewed the debate on the future of the metaverse. While the exhibitors were all agog about it, the experts on panels suggested moving ahead with caution



Larger than life holograms that can be used for live-streaming, demonstrated by HyperVSN at CES 2023 (Courtesy: CES, HyperVSN and Brian Kong)



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It was evident from the videos that visitors to the Central Hall at CES 2023 were enjoying the immersive treat spread out for them by various metaverse tech companies exhibiting their ware. On the other hand were the expert panels trying to arrive at a reasonable definition for the metaverse, and to figure out how it might really be used and by whom. Together they managed to once again fire the imaginations of those who had almost written off the metaverse as empty hype. And well, we got a great spin for our quarterly update.

What is the metaverse?

Despite everyone talking about it, this question never ceases to exist. Every panel discussion on the metaverse seems to start with how it can be defined. During the “The Road to the Open Metaverse” session at the global technology conference in CES 2023, Neil Trevett, Vice President - Developer Ecosystems, Nvidia, and Chairman of the Metaverse Standards Forum, described the metaverse as a virtual world that combines the connectivity of the Web with the immersivity of spatial computing. “It’s GPUs, it’s extended real-